

CONSTITUTION

Article 1

Kingsville Baptist Church located in Kingsville, Missouri is a non-profit organization under the laws of the State of Missouri. Kingsville Baptist Church is an autonomous self-governing church that voluntarily cooperates with and supports the West Central Baptist Association, Missouri Baptist Convention, and Southern Baptist Convention.

Article 2

Mission Statement: We exist as a church to worship God, to evangelize the lost, minister to the needy, disciple believers, and fellowship together as the Body of Christ.

Article 3

We affirm the Holy Bible as the inspired, infallible word of God and the basis for our beliefs. This church subscribes to the doctrinal statement of the Baptist Faith and Message as adopted by the Southern Baptist Convention in 2000. We voluntarily band ourselves together as a body of baptized believers in Jesus Christ, personally committed to sharing the good news of salvation.

Article 4

An opportunity for individuals to make a profession of faith in Jesus Christ as their Savior or apply for membership into the church body shall be given at each Sunday morning service.

Article 5

Business of the church will be voted on in the regularly scheduled business meeting by attending church members. A majority vote passes items that are voted on except as stated in the by-laws. The moderator will have the deciding vote in case of a tie vote.

Church Bylaws

Article 1: Membership

Any individual may ask to become a candidate for membership in this church. The membership reserves the exclusive right to determine who shall be members of this church and the conditions of such membership. All such candidates shall be presented to the church at any regular church service for membership in any of the following ways:

1. By profession of faith in Jesus Christ as their Savior and Lord and for baptism according to the policies of this church.
2. By promise of letter from another Baptist Church.
3. By statement of prior profession of faith and believer's baptism by immersion.

*New members or new member candidates are expected to participate in the church's new member orientation class.

Article 2: Rights of Members

1. Every member of the church (who is in good standing with the church) is entitled a vote at all elections and on all questions submitted to the church providing the member is present at the time of voting.
2. Every member of the church (who is in good standing with the church) is eligible for consideration by the membership as candidates for elective offices in the church.

Article 3: Termination of Membership

Membership shall end in the following ways:

1. Transfer to another Baptist Church by letter.
2. Exclusion, by action of the church.
3. Removal when a member requests it or when they unite with another church who does not request letters.
4. Death

Under no circumstances in any of the above instances, other than death, can a member be taken from the church role without a vote of the church.

Article 4: Forfeiture of Good Standing

A person who has not had fellowship in the activities of this church within a period of one year shall forfeit his right to participate in any business activities of this church. Reinstatement of good standing will occur when the member resumes fellowship with any of the activities of this church within a period of one month. Conditions of health will be considered on an individual basis as a possible exception.

Article 5: Church Discipline

Disciplinary procedures for unchristian conduct of members of the church shall be based on Matthew 18. If trouble arises between members of the church, the proper Scriptural steps shall be followed before grievances are brought before the church.

The church may restore membership to any person previously excluded, upon request of the excluded person, and by $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the members present upon evidence of the excluded person's repentance and reformation of behavior.

Article 6: Church Leaders

Section 1: Ministerial Staff

The ministerial staff shall consist of a Senior Pastor and any other ministerial staff deemed necessary by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at business meeting.

Section 2: Deacons

Deacons may be elected from time to time by the church either to fill a vacancy or to increase the number of deacons as deemed necessary by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at business meeting.

Section 3: Officers

The officers of Kingsville Baptist Church will include a church clerk, church treasurer, church trustees, and other offices as deemed necessary by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at business meeting.

Section 4: Teachers, all Other Workers, and Committees

Teachers, all other workers and committees must be approved by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at business meeting.

Article 7: Process of Identifying Church Leaders

Prayer plays a vital part in the processes of identifying church leaders!

Section 1: Ministerial Staff

A. Senior Pastor

1. A Search Committee will be formed and voted on by the church.
2. The recommended male candidate will be brought before the church by the Search Committee.
3. The candidate will preach in view of a call before the congregation and a vote of the congregation to follow that day. This will be announced a minimum of two weeks prior. A call will be extended to the candidate if there is a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting.

B. Other Ministerial Staff

1. A Search Committee will be formed and voted on by the church.
2. The recommended candidate will be brought before the church by the Search Committee.

3. The candidate will preach or share their testimony before the congregation with a vote of the congregation to follow that day. This will be announced a minimum of two weeks prior. A call will be extended to the candidate if there is a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church members present at the business meeting.

Section 2: Deacons

1. The deacons will recommend to the church a man or men to be considered as deacons.
2. The church will vote on the candidate(s). A $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting is needed for the candidate(s) to begin the deacon training and ordination process. The deacon candidate(s) will be announced a minimum of two weeks prior to the vote.
3. The approved deacon candidate(s) will then be deacon(s) in training for a minimum of six months. This steps will be waived for candidates that were previously ordained and have serve at another Baptist church.
4. The candidate(s) will be ordained in a special service that the whole church will be encouraged to attend.

Section 3: Officers

Officers will be recommended by the Nominating Committee and must receive a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting.

Section 4: Teachers, all Other Workers, and Committees

Teachers, all other workers, and committees will be recommended by the Nominating Committee and must receive a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting.

Section 5: Expectations

All church leaders are expected to lead by example regarding attendance, support, and involvement in the activities of the church.

Article 8: Process of Termination of Church Leaders

Section 1: Ministerial Staff

The Pastor chosen by the church shall continue as Pastor until he resigns, or his service is terminated by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting (this vote will be announced at least two weeks prior to the business meeting), or by his death.

Section 2: Deacons

The Deacons chosen by the church shall continue as Deacons until they resign, or the service is terminated by $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting (this vote will be announced at least two weeks prior to the business meeting), or by their death.

Section 3: Officers

Officers will serve for one year and then may or may not be re-nominated by the Nominating Committee and approved by the church vote. An officer may be removed by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting. This vote will be announced at least two weeks prior to the business meeting.

Section 4: Teachers, all Other Workers, and Committees

Teachers, all other workers, and committees will serve for one year and then may or not not be re-nominated by the Nominating Committee and approved by the church vote. Teachers, all other workers, and committee members may be removed by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting. This meeting will be announced at least two weeks prior to the business meeting.

Article 9: Ordinances

Section 1: Baptism

This church shall receive for baptism any person who has received Jesus Christ as their Savior by professing Him publicly at any worship service, and indicates a commitment to follow Jesus as Lord. Baptism will be by immersion in water. The Pastor or whomever is designated by the church shall baptize the individual as an act of worship during any Worship Service.

Section 2: Lord's Supper (Communion)

It shall be the duty of the church to observe the Lord's Supper at least once per quarter during its regular services. The Lord's Supper shall be open to all born-again believers.

Article 10: Church Policies

New Church policies will be presented in Business Meeting and will become policy by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present at the business meeting. These new policies will be announced at least two weeks prior to the business meeting.

Article 11: Amendments

Changes in this Constitution and By-Laws may be made at any regular business meeting of this church, provided each amendment shall have been presented in writing and with copies available to church members present. These proposed changes must be available at least two weeks prior to the business meeting. A $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the church present during the business meeting will be required for the amendment or by-laws to pass and become a part of the document.

ADDENDUM

Church Covenant

We will meet with one another consistently.

We will pray for one another regularly.

We will serve one another selflessly.

We will forgive one another as Christ has forgiven us.

We will rejoice at each other's happiness and seek to bear one another's burdens with tenderness and empathy. We will encourage one another with our speech and our actions and we will spur one another toward love and good deeds.

We will humbly and gently correct one another and receive correction from one another according to a Biblical understanding of discipline and restoration.